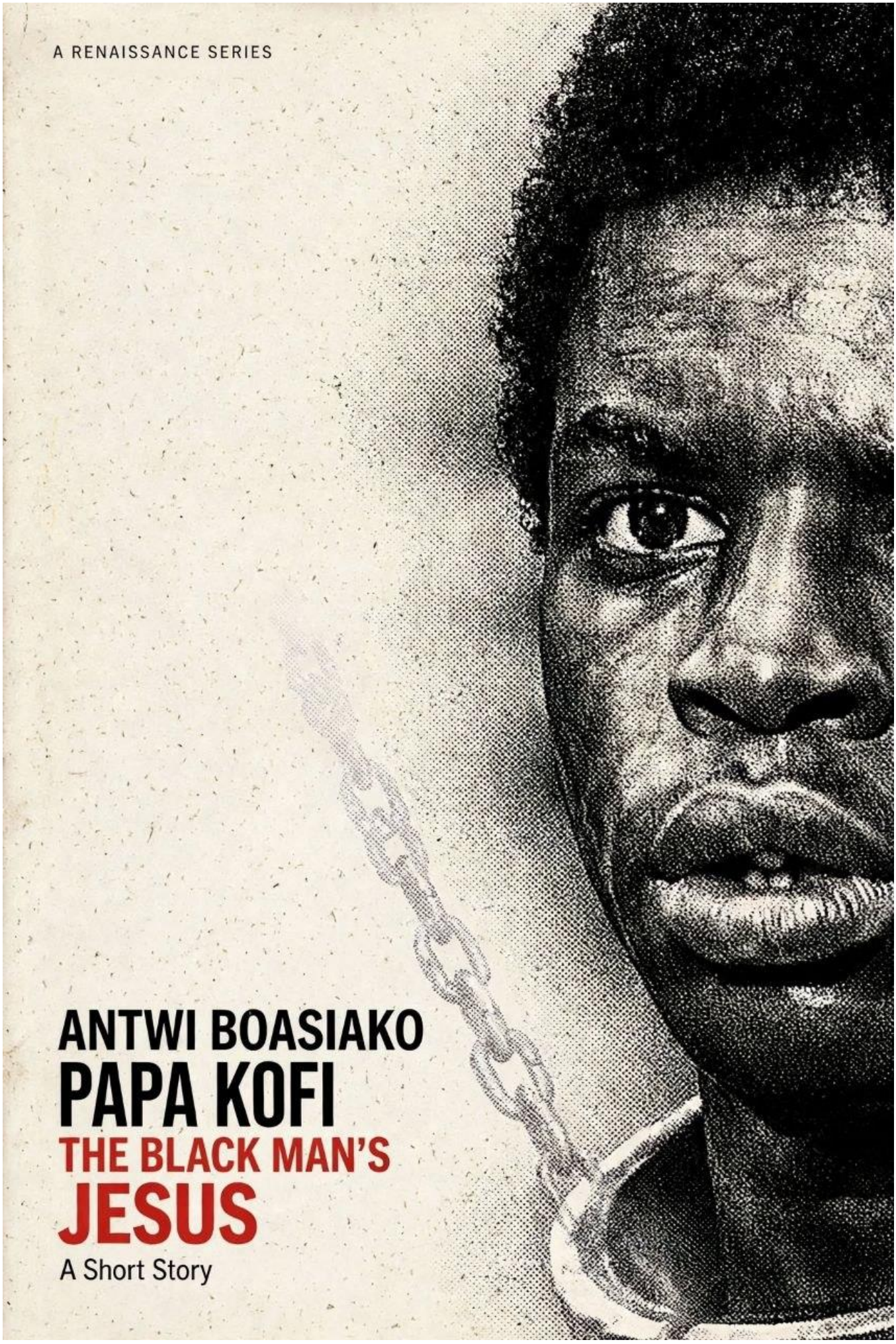
A RENAISSANCE SERIES



ANTWI BOASIAKO

PAPA KOFI
THE BLACK MAN'S JESUS

A Short Story

THE BLACK MAN'S JESUS

A SHORT STORY

Antwi Boasiako Papa Kofi

“ Greater love has no one than this: to lay down one’s life for one’s friends.”

John 15:13

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It was a hot day in the dungeons of the Cape Coast Castle. Hot as always, ironically. Not because the Gold Coast sun was shining so hard on the people, but because a thousand men turned slaves were packed like sardines in a dungeon no bigger than a passenger bus. The obnoxious smell of faeces, cornmeal and sweat filled the room. Their only source of ventilation? A rectangle-shaped hole that gave some sunshine and a hint of fresh air. Guess what, it wasn't working. But who cared about a bunch of sweaty, chained, and smelly negroes anyway? It was 1767. The Trans-Atlantic slave trade was the 'ish' of that time. The natives were captured and put in dungeons, treated no better than a dog, because of human wickedness.

Kwamina was one of the fortunate men to be captured by those *Obroni* men. Pale, white men with weapons that shoot death and sound like the claps of thunder. They raided his village, killed his only son, and took his wife and him as prizes of conquest. The next month, he found himself in the dungeon of Cape Coast Castle, sharing space with men from other villages. Some of his friends were there with him, hungry, sweaty, smelly. Kwamina couldn't shake the memory of seeing his little boy shot down by those damned men's weapons. *Wicked men! Who shoots a four-year-old?* Thoughts ran frantically through his mind, and the fact that his dear wife was in another dungeon, far from his loving touch was what cut deep in his heart. He may not see his wife again. He wept silently, and stared into the small rectangle-shaped hole in the top part of the dungeon.

Was there ever going to be another chance to see the sun again?



Jeffrey was that chill guy that everyone liked. Smart, charming, good looking- just a 10/10 guy. He was a Political Science major at one of the top Ivy League schools in the United States. Brilliant student, that guy, just simply sharp. It's the 15th of October 2025, and Jeffrey was celebrating a very special day in his life- his 19th birthday.

Jeffrey wasn't the normal "give-me a birthday present, come to my birthday party" kind of guy; nah, bro believed he had totally evolved past that. Sadly, his good friends were pestering him to join them at a party one of the frats on campus was having. A fraternity is a society on campus that's formed for specific reasons. This frat was a black fraternity, so calling it a "frat" was like insulting their mothers, or something. Jeffrey was of Ghanaian descent. His mom a Ghanaian woman, born, bred, and raised in the Ghanaian culture. His dad, also of Ghanaian descent, but spent most of his life in the US. He was a mixture of Ghanaian values and a straight-outta-Compton kind of man.
Since it was his birthday, Mommy was going to call him 'unexpectedly' as a 'surprise' to 'surprise' him on his birthday.

The call is probably coming right about... now.

Ring-ring.

He picks the call. "My sooooooooooooooon!!! Happy Birthday to you! I love you sooooo much! Eeeeeekk!!" Jeffrey mutters some pretty embarrassing words under his breath and responds to his mom, "Mommyyy, thank you!" he said with his totally fake cheery voice.

"I wanted to surprise you, you know. Just so you know I never forgot."

"Mom, you've been "surprising" me since I was in third grade, I'm pretty sure this doesn't count as a surprise." he said with a flat tone.

"Oh don't be such a grinch, honey, your son is being grumpy again!" His mom called out to his dad. Daddy responded from the background, "Be nice to ya mother, Jeff."

"Alright." Jeffrey rolled his eyes at his dad's comment over the phone. "How's school though?"

"School's fine Mom; it has always been fine."

Mom sighed, "Jeff, you know we really want to be with you; it's not our fault we are out here again. God has called us to the mission field once again. The burden was too heavy to ignore, Jeff, and you know it."

Mom and Dad were missionaries in Africa, teaching, converting, and helping people become more Christ-like. Mom was a medicine student when she met Dad, a radical Philosophy major at Howard University. They met at a debate on whether segregation was relevant or not, and Dad totally cooked his opponent and won the debate. His friends likened him to Malcom X or Martin Luther King Jr, because Dad had a passion for the black community. When the two met, some would say it was love at first handshake, or sight, or whatever they call it. From that time on, they were inseparable. Till Dad encountered the LORD and gave his life to Jesus. He became radically transformed by the Gospel. He started taking Mom to church dates instead of movie dates, and gradually, Mom also gave her life to Jesus. When they graduated, they got married a year after. That's when Dad sensed a call to being a missionary, left his secular job, and followed the Lord’s leading. They had established a missions house in Africa, back in Ghana, their motherland, and they were flourishing. Jeff, on the other hand, did not give a (cuss word) for whatever they were doing. He lost faith when he was 13 years. So whatever they were doing in Africa was not his business.
"You always say that, Mom. I mean, can God just give me my parents? Jeez, seem you're more of a mom to those bastards in Afri-"

"Don't call them that, Jeff!", Mom said sternly.

"I want my mom back."

"I'll always be there for you, Jeff. I always have! Your dad and I still love you dearly. You're never alone." Suddenly, the voice over the phone changes to a masculine voice, with a pinch of a Compton-based accent. "Son, I know these are trying times for you, but you will always be our son. But right now, God has put us in Ghana. We wished so much to take you along with us, but your schooling wouldn't allow you. But look, no matter what happens, Nothing can separate - "

"Separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus, Romans 8:38, sure Dad, our love is so strong that nothing can break it. Yay, what a word." Legendary words from the birthday boy. "We'll call you again soon, we promise. Have a great day, Jeff."

"Bye bye to you too." Jeff cut the call and threw his phone onto his bed. Another day in this God-forsaken University, in this God-forsaken world, with this God-forsaken life.

Happy birthday to me.

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Jeff made his way to the lecture room and found his way to his favourite spot in the room, the left corner of the room, which was four rows away from the first seat. His course mates made their way to their own seats and went back to conversing, doomscrolling, or just sitting still till the lecturer came. Professor Hopkins, their philosophy lecturer, came in with her teaching assistants holding her stuff as she rushed her way to the podium, knowing very well that she was five minutes late. "Good morning, students! I am so sorry that I showed up at this ungodly time." *You're only five minutes late*, Jeff thought, as he looked at this uptight woman set up her lecture to present. "Okay guys, today, I would not waste your time; I am giving you all a project to work on." Murmurs and groans filled the lecture room. "All of you are going to do some history digging! The question is simple: what important part of history was greatly influenced, shaped, or changed by religious or philosophical views held by the people or a group of people in that era? I want you all to think outside of the box. Read, research, and do all you can, and for the love of God, none of you should bring me a ChatGPT-generated work, please." Professor Hopkins' comment sparked a wave of giggles across the room.
"Now all of you know my norm," she continued, "I would normally group you all into pairs, but this time, I want to test the performance of the entire class, so I'm making all of you do individual work. This project is going to contribute a huge percentage to your GPA, students; don't play with it. Okay then, let's 'call it a day. I will meet you all next week, same time!" What a birthday, no class

for the rest of the day. Now that's the life. Students happily chattered and got out of their seats and walked towards the exit.

Jeff's two best friends, Jayda, an African American girl with a little too much of an attitude, and Bruce, the only white boy who got him, walked up from behind him and jumped onto him like he was their prey. "Happy Birthday!" Jeff turned around, not really shocked, but a little bit surprised that at least someone didn't forget. But it wasn't as if his parents forgot, or did he think they forgot? You know what, never mind. "Guys, you remembered!" He said with a huge smile on his face. If anyone could turn him into a smiley-faced goof, it would be those two. "How would we ever forget you, homeboy!" Jayda said to him, while poking his stomach with her two index fingers playfully. Bruce started ranting in excitement, "Bro, we were literally planning for this day, and you know what's going to happen tonight? Drumroll, please!" Bruce gestured towards Jayda, and she began a very bad imitation of a drumroll. "The Omega Rave! " They said together with so much excitement. Jeff rolled his eyes at them and just laughed it away. "Okay, okay, I'll go to the stupid party with y'all". Jayda did a mini celebration fist pump. "Only on one condition," Jeff continued. "Okay, what's that?" Bruce asked. "No booze". Jeff said sternly. Jeff had a zero-tolerance policy for alcohol. He may not have been a Christian anymore, but he did not want that stuff in his body. Jayda and Bruce looked at each other and grinned. "Deal", Jayda said, shaking up the birthday boy, as they dapped out of the lecture room. "It's going to be so much fun!"

I hope so.



Kwamina sat quietly, staring at the rectangle-shaped hole near the ceiling of the dungeon. He was thinking to himself.

Can I fit through that hole? *What if I don't eat for some days? Maybe I can escape, maybe-*

His thoughts were interrupted by a loud creak from the opened dungeon gate. Those "Obroni" men didn't open the gates often. Today happened to be one of those days. A white man in a brown army suit walked in and searched around. Then his eyes landed on his target. Onyimdze, Kwamina's good friend and workmate, had recently fallen terribly ill because of the living conditions. In his state, it seemed there was no path back to restoration. They were going to finish him. The white man ordered the other soldiers he came in with to come and carry Onyimdze from where he was to where he was going to be: eternity. Kwamina watched as his good friend was being carried away.

Then, that's when he noticed something.

One of the soldiers who were carrying his dear friend away was wearing something on his wrist. A bracelet. Not an ordinary bracelet, a bracelet made out of cowries. Cowries that had a certain insignia that only one family had in his whole village: his family. That bracelet that damned white soldier wore belonged to his wife.

That could only mean one *thing*.

Rage rose in the heart of Kwamina; he wanted to take a stone and kill this excuse for a man. He wanted to strangle him till he died. So many wicked thoughts came to him as if they were flowing from the devil himself. Kwamina shot up to his feet and shouted at the soldier.

"Hey!" he shouted. All eyes turned towards him, but the soldiers ignored him. "Hey, you!" He said in Fante, "Where did you get that thing on your hand?" The soldier turned and looked at him as if he was running mad.

"I said, where did you get that bracelet?" He reiterated and pointed to the soldier's wrist. The soldier automatically understood. He looked at the bracelet and gave a dirty smirk. Oh, how Kwamina wished to slap that smirk off his face! He lunged at the soldier and bit him on the arm, then started throwing punches at his face, just to make sure that he would teach him a lesson of his life.

Luckily, the chain on his ankle was long enough to make that happen. His fellow soldier tried to peel Kwamina away with force, and the senior white officer called out for reinforcements while muttering something about 'bloody savages'. The fight was so bad that they forgot about Onyimdze altogether. Finally, they were able to peel Kwamina off the soldier. He had a bloody nose and a bloody bite mark on his arm. That's when he realized it: Kwamina had a similar bracelet on his wrist. The soldiers held Kwamina down, as the senior officer approached Kwamina with an annoyed, infuriated look.

"Take him to the Condemned Cell!"



Jeff lay on his bed and was thinking of the best way he could celebrate the day. He was very aware of his friends' request- no, not request, their persistent pestering for him to join them at the incoming rave. Jeff, for the longest time, was not really a people person. People like him, brilliant, dashing, charming, saw themselves to be way over that, you know.

The level of arrogance his mind had reached could've been termed a superpower.

He hadn't been a people person even when he was in church. Speaking of church, Jeff left structure a long time ago. It was exactly 6 years ago that Jeff deconstructed faith and became basically agnostic. He saw the corruption, coldness, and heartlessness of the church. How love was missing from that place they called ‘The House of God’. Really? The same church that discriminated against his own father after he offered to do God's work with them? The same church that was a clout-seeking, money-loving, people-hating cult? He didn't think it was worth something believing in.
As he lay on the bed, reminiscing about all those bad memories, his phone began to ring. It was Jayda.

"Hello?" He spoke.

"Heyyyy bud, you getting ready?" *Sigh, always persistent. Annoyingly persistent.* "No, I'm about to get ready. Is Bruce around?"

"Yes, he is!" Then a brief silence.

"Jeff."

"Yeah."

"Please show up."

This time, it sounded like she was serious. "You know it's been 3 years since-"
"Yeah, since I almost threw myself off a bridge, you don't have to remind me."
Jeff was suicidal. But that's a story for another day.

"I said I'll make it, don't sweat it." He said quite convincingly. Jayda suddenly switched from being a woman to being a Harley Quinn type of chic. "Okayy, can't wait to see youu, byeeee!"

"Bye Jay." He cut the call. He checked his time; it was 12 pm in the afternoon. Still had a lot of time to burn.
He got off his bed and walked towards his study desk. Maybe I could use this time to begin the project. *I'm sure I could be done by tomorrow*. Procrastination was not his thing; an honourable behaviour coming from a heathen. He thought of what to research and read. Then it just clicked in his mind. Dad was so passionate about the black community that he had a mini library with some of the best authors from the black community. The W.E. Duboises, the Martin Luther Kings, The Malcolm X's. Even James Baldwin, even though he didn't really agree with everything he said. Jeff loved reading them; he even read some of the abolitionists. (Did I say this kid is smart?). So he was just going to write something on slavery.

Yeah, Slavery, that'll work.

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It was getting close to 12 am. Jeff was just getting ready to join his friends at the rave. He felt like the reverse of Cinderella, just that he was black and the party was just about to begin. He Ubered himself to the party house, getting ready to lose himself.

Hey, it was his birthday.

Headed to the door and opened it. The place was dreadfully quiet for a rave, and dark. He saw some cars outside, but it looked as if he was too early, or too late. He couldn't tell. Jayda called him before he ordered a ride. So he was definitely sure he would come to meet th-

"Surpriiise!!"

Those little cunning foxes.

Now that's what we call a surprise. Not Mom's lame ones.



Reverend Father Archibald Coffie was the first ordained black priest to be on the Cape Coast Castle. He was a priest unlike any other you may have seen. He was taken to go and study abroad as a young boy. He eventually enrolled himself in training for ministry and thus became a clergyman for the Anglican church. As a representative of the Church in England, he was posted to the castle to lead services and carry out every clergyman's duty. There was only one problem. He was a black man in a castle filled with enslaved black people. There were times he would hear the cries and groans of his own countrymen while he conducted services. You know why? Because the church building was built on top of the dungeons. The amount of cruelty he saw was heartbreaking. Some people thought that he was a cold man who didn't care for his fellow countrymen, but they were wrong. Father Archibald was posted to the castle around 1765. He had served for two years; he saw the terror and torture his own fellow humans went through.

Father Archibald sat behind his desk in his room as he put quill to parchment. As he wrote these letters, tears fell from his cheeks onto the paper. It had been like that for a year now. Father Archibald wrote consistently to the church officers back in London, and to some North American Abolitionists in his day. He wrote about the cruelty the officers showed to the slaves. Their living conditions and just how evil all that web was. The horrors of the Trans-Atlantic slave trade had vexed his soul so much that his heart bled every time he heard the faint cries of his people, or the shouts of the women that were raped by the officers.

Women like Kwamina's wife.

Father Archibald wiped his tears with the back of his palm, and packed up his letters to be ready to be posted to his audience. Father Archibald could not confront the authorities head-on, because they were literally the reason why he was in the castle in the first place. He may not have chosen to bite the hand that fed him. But he just had to do something.

****

It was a hot afternoon in the castle, and Father Archibald was going about his daily duties. As he was going down to his private quarters, he overheard two officers talking about something. Officers always talk about something, but this one felt different. He went closer to eavesdrop on them.

"That savage really left a mark on you, didn't he?" the first one asked.

"Oh, it was terrible, almost bit me arm off, mate!" the second voice said. It sounded like he was in pain. Father Archibald peered long enough to see a big bite mark on his arm.

"These crazy blackamoors. What was his problem anyways?"

"Something about this bracelet," he gestured to his wrist, "I don't know if it's a generational treasure of some sort."

"Where did you get that, old boy?" The first officer looked closely at the ornamental wristlet on his comrade's wrist.

"From some wench I shagged some days ago; I just thought what she was wearing was pretty, you know." What dumb words from an extremely dumb man.

"Old boy." The first officer sighed and face-palmed, obviously overwhelmed by the stupidity of his comrade. "What?" he replied, obviously oblivious of the harm he had caused.

"That 'wench' was that man's wife!"

"Oh." Very stupid guy. "Hell, how was I supposed to know?"

"You know what, it's alright. All that matters is that whatever that was over, and that guy is in the condemned cell."

The Condemned Cell.

Father Archibald's heart skipped a beat. That was a phrase no black man in the castle would want to hear. "Yeah, serves him right!" the second officer said loudly, and winced in pain. Served him right.

Father Archibald left that scene burdened much more than ever. He had to do something. No more cowardice. Something had to be done. By any means necessary.



Jeff woke up the next day with a terrible hangover. His head hurt so much it felt like he fell down the stairs headfirst last night. Did he, though? He couldn't remember a thing. He finally broke his zero-tolerance policy on alcohol. One tiny shot turned into two, two turned to four, and the multiplication just kept going. He checked the time and freaked; it was 9 am! His heart skipped a beat, then he realised it was Saturday. Saved by the calendar. The effects of booze. He took a shower and looked at the chats he had received. Jayda had sent him loads of pictures of last night to him. Boy, did he clown himself yesternight. He got dressed and headed to the library. He had an assignment to complete.

Jeff opened the library door and headed towards the librarian, Mrs. Wheatley. Mrs Wheatley was quite accustomed to the young man approaching her. He was a regular. She greeted him with one of her custom black woman, glasses-tipped-down-to-her-nose kind of smiles. "How're we doing today, Mr. Mensah?" Mrs Wheatley loved to call him by his surname. Heritage was as important to her as water to plants. "A good day to you too, Mrs. Wheatley." Jeff completely avoids Mrs. Wheatley's question for no reason.

"What brings you to my humble abode, again." she said comically.

"I'm writing something on slavery for my philosophy class. I need some readings to carry that out."

"Slavery and Philosophy, now, that's a combo I ain't never heard of." Mrs. Wheatley said playfully.

"Yup, we're always on the new, you know."

"But what exactly was the question given to y'all? I want to know, so we can get the right books." She said as she scribbled down something on a card.
"Oh, yeah, umm, something about how religious philosophical views shaped some happenings in history and the people who held them. Yeah, something along those lines." Mrs Wheatley looked at him funny.

"But why slavery then?" Then he gave a little smirk.

"Well, you know, slavery, Christianity, basically siblings, I guess?" Now Mrs. Wheatley was well aware that her dear boy was a heathen. But she couldn't hold back her long sigh. But she looked at him once more and smiled.

Lemme give this boy a chance.

"Follow me." Jeff followed Mrs. Wheatley into one of the discussion rooms. She walked toward the shelf and pulled out a vintage book. That book looked like it lived to see World War 1. She blew the dust off the book to give a kind of dramatic vibe, but they both ended up coughing and sneezing.

"Whoa, that's not what I thought it would be." She said while laughing heartily. "You know," she continued, "this book has what you need, but to get and understand the story, you're going to need a narrator. Tell you everything you need to know, capiche?" Jeff pulled out his notebook and pen. He was born ready.

"In the year 1765, the Church in England ordained a young black man as a priest. Black ordained priests were rare to find in their day. His name was Archibald Coffie." Mrs. Wheatley opened the book and showed him the picture of Father Archibald. "He lived in a pretty compromising position. He ministered to the white people the message of God's goodness and graciousness, while his fellow countrymen writhed in sorrow and pain beneath him." Jeff giggled under his breath. That's how *all* those Christians are. "Now don't be quick to judge him. Archibald was doing everything that he could, but frequently wrote to the church, trying to create awareness of this cruelty. Until one day, he just had enough. He overheard two soldiers talk about one slave thrown into a condemned dungeon. A dungeon where the slave is deprived of water, food, and even ventilation. He lives in thick darkness and is literally left to die. That's when he made up his mind."

"Made his mind to do what?"



Father Archibald had made up his mind to go to the condemned cell at midnight to go and see that slave that was left to die. He couldn't live as a coward anymore. Something had to be done. Someone had to get something done. He took a dark cloak and took food and water with him. That man must have been starving to death. He took a moderate sum of money, money that could be used to bribe a bunch of low-life soldiers. He took his kerosene lantern and looked into the mirror. It was now or never. Going to the condemned cells was like giving the queen of England a slap in the face. It was treason. But he had to do it anyways.

Father Archibald walked down the tunnels, down to the dark gates of the condemned cell. There, a lazy, drunk ward sat, dozing off. If I try to sneak in, the gate will make noise. The loud creak will give me away, Archibald thought to himself. *Lord, help me*.

"Hey!" Archibald called the sleeping ward out of dreamville.

"Wai- wait a minute, who goes there?" the painfully drunk ward responded.

"By the orders of the governor, I am here to see the man in this cell. Open up now." The ward paused for a bit, then eyed the cloaked figure from top to bottom. "Do I know ya, old boy?"

Uh oh.

Archibald started to sweat under his heavy dark cloak. But he kept quiet and kept his calm. Then the ward shrugged and opened the gate to the cell. Turns out he didn't need to bring bribe money then. The cell was pitch black. The darkness was so thick you could feel it. The light from Archibald's kerosene lamp shone onto a lean figure in the middle of the cell who seemed to have been asleep till the light shone upon him.
"Who is that?" Kwamina said in Fante. The man sounded so weak that when Archibald heard his voice, his heart broke at once. Archibald had forgotten most of his Fante. He was just 10 years old when they took him away from the Gold Coast. Nevertheless, he struggled to communicate his heart to the dying man.

"Don't worry, a friend has come." Archibald said in the small Fante he could muster at the moment. He offered him the food and water, and boy, was Kwamina hungry. Archibald started to weep at this sight. He couldn't keep this sight anymore. It was too much to bear. He wished he could run out with the man and set him free. Free from all this wickedness. But that wasn't just possible. If all he could give was a flicker of hope, then he would do that gladly. He sat beside Kwamina and began to pour out his heart.

"It is well, my brother. Though darkness may last for the night, joy will come." As he said this, tears fell from his eyes. Kwamina looked at him and smiled. "Thank you. You are a true brother."

Then that's when the Holy Ghost moved in Archibald's heart with strong compassion. He gave Kwamina a hug and wept over him like a baby. He just couldn't let this man perish like that. He had to tell him the good news.

"Jesus loves you, my brother. He wants you to live with him in eternity, but when you accept him, you'll live with him forever."

"Jesus, who is he?"

"He is your Lord, your saviour. I want to lead you to him." Archibald couldn't hold back his tears.

"Lead me to this Jesus. I want to know him."



"Wow". Jeff was just speechless over what he had just heard. For more than half of his life, the church was just a fat graveyard, and Christians were literal zombies with no compassion. But this man opened his eyes to what he may not have noticed.

His Mom and Dad weren't bad people themselves; they were just... awkward. But this man's love was different. He wished he had experienced similar love.

"Yup. That was the story of Rev. Father Archibald Coffie. A true man of God indeed. I would say this is a significant portion of history. Going to the cells was the end of his career and his days as a free man, but he risked his freedom for what really mattered. A fellow brother."
What if this Christianity thing isn't a scam? Thoughts ran wild in Jeff's mind. What if what he may have thought was true was actually prejudice?

"I am speechless. I've never heard of such humanitarian feats like this. Why haven't I ever heard of him?" Jeff probed further. The story had to be fake. No one in their right mind would do that. Not even Gandhi would do such a thing. Or Confucius. Or Muhammad. Definitely not Muhammad. "I'm sure you've heard of a greater feat— The Lord Jesus did greater than something greater than what Archibald did. Archibald was just simply copying what his saviour did."
Mrs. Wheatley leaned in, "This Christianity thing, son, is more than just a religion. It's life. It's the only way of really living. The slaves may have been tortured by men who professed it, and their wickedness seemed to put insult on Jesus' name, but ask yourself a question, Jeff: if someone played Beethoven badly, does that mean Beethoven was a bad composer? No sir! It means the player is the bad player. Jesus will stay the saviour of the world, misrepresented by white folk or not." Mrs. Wheatley peered through her glasses at the young man sitting across the table from her.
"But— but that doesn't cancel many years of oppression, cruelty and— and— and pure evil!" Jeff just couldn't get the right words.

There had to be a more convincing reason.

"That's the truth, Jeffrey. It always has. I in no way support what the white folks did to our people, but the truth remains the truth, no matter how heavy it may be."

The room went silent.

Jeff took up his stuff and walked towards the exit. But truth will always prevail, and it did at that moment. Jeff turned and looked at Mrs. Wheatley. "I will think of everything you have said today, Ma'am. Thank you so much." With that, he left the room. Mrs. Wheatley looked on as he went through the doors.

He'll get it someday.



Father Archibald sat in his study pondering on the word of God. He was preparing for service for the next day, Sunday. He was thinking of preaching on something about injustice; yes, that'll strike a chord.

His ponderings were interrupted when he heard the officers shouting something to their fellow officers. What they were saying sounded like a code they used when a slave had died in the dungeon, and they had to take his or her body out of the dungeon to bury them. Archibald left his study to see what that was all about. He saw the officers carry the body of the person wrapped in a white cloth. Poor soul.

He called out to one of the officers standing by to see what was going on. "Uhh, good sir," Archibald called out, "what is going on down there?" The officer turned and did a little curtsy. He was the chaplain of the castle after all. "Reverend Father, one of the slaves just passed away. He was put in one of the condemned cells a while ago for assaulting an officer."

Oh no.

"Which officer? How was he assaulted?" It couldn't be the person he was thinking. "Oh, that savage did a number on the officer, sir; almost bit his arm off."

Oh no.

Oh no.

No. A stray tear rolled down Father Archibald's face; what he had feared had come to pass.

"Are you okay, sir?" The officer asked in delirium of whatever that was. Father Archibald turned slowly and walked into the room without saying a word. He wept in intercession for his people for the rest of the day.

He was feeling like Moses.



Another long day for class had dawned on Jeff. There he was, in another philosophy class. Mrs. Hopkins had finished lecturing and had closed the class. Jeff was just about to leave, till he felt someone tap his shoulder. It's probably Jayda. *I am not going to another rave in my life*.

It was not Jayda.

One of Mrs. Hopkins' teaching assistants had gestured towards where Mrs. Hopkins was standing. "She's calling you." Well, that's weird. Jeff walked behind the teaching assistant as they approached Mrs. Hopkins. She was wearing a big smile. Now Jeff was even more confused when he saw that.

"Mr. Mensah, how're you today?" she asked with that wide smile plastered on her face. "I'm doing well, ma'am." "Well, Mr. Mensah, I must say, I am very impressed with the work you brought in last week. Absolute genius." They submitted the assignment a week ago. Apparently, Mrs. Hopkins is speaking like Jeff's work deserved a Pulitzer Prize or something. "And you know something, I want you to specially present your work to the class. I just love how you presented the case of Christianity and slavery. Oh, and that story of the Reverend Father, deeply moving. Alright, see you next week!" Mrs Hopkins walked out of the lecture room, leaving Jeff in a pool of thoughts.

Jeff turned towards the lecture room and grinned.

Looks like he's an evangelist now. Just like Mom and Dad.



Author's Note

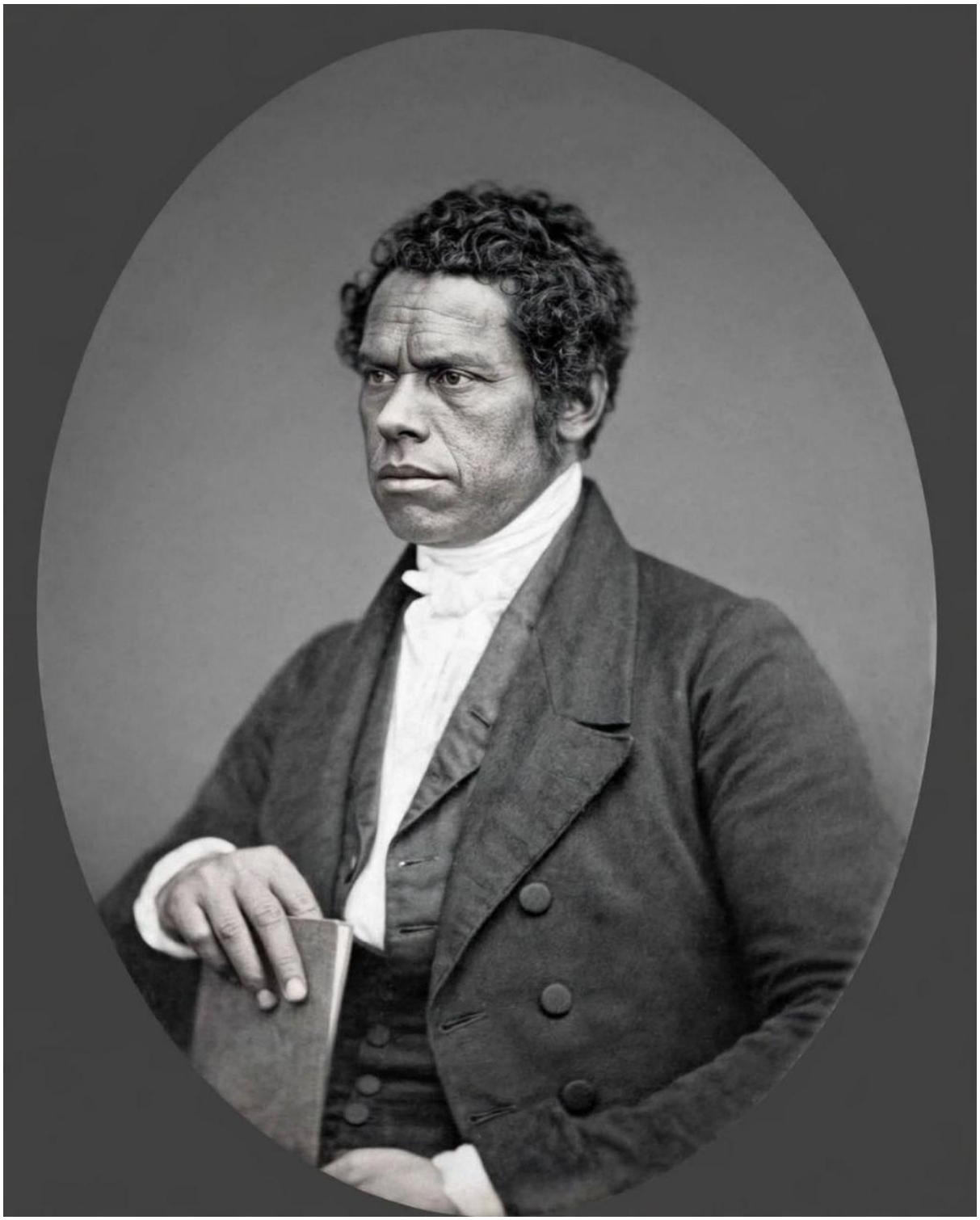
This short story, first of all, sprang from the place of prayer. Hence, I do not doubt that it may cause many to be moved into compassion or rise with a burden to see him glorified.

Although every character in the story is fictional, I drew inspiration from history and the story of Phillip Quaque, the first black ordained priest to serve as a chaplain in a castle that housed enslaved people. Nevertheless, my heart desires that we would come to know what unconditional love is, and how we can reproduce it.

This short story is a call to the church to cultivate the heart of love. The type that drove Jesus to the cross.

The story is also symbolic in a sense. In my mind's eye, I envisioned the slaves to be just slaves. But those slaves could be likened to our brethren in the world, *slaves to sin*. Will you be like Father Archibald, or will you continue to frolic in your comfort zone? You were called out *for such a time as this*.

I hope this story sticks with you. Until the next story from the Renaissance series.



In Memory of Rev. Father Philip Quaque

1741-1816